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Mid and Senior Site Reliability Engineer (Platform Engineering/Identity/Azure)

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:00 pm on Monday 24th August 2026



Government
Digital Service

Reference number

475601

Salary

£56,850 - £81,720

The base salary of this grade is £61,620 for London and £56,850 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay

allowance. £69,220 - £81,720 (London) and £64,450 - £76,950 (National Locations) Based on capability.

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GDS - Technology & Security

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

3

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Location

London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and at the forefront of coordinating the UK's geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We're part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you'll be working with some of the world's most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation's highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need.

About Engineering Enablement

Part of the newly formed Platform Engineering, Resilience and Cyber directorate, the Engineering Enablement programme is boosting efficiency, strengthening security, and improving developer experience by providing infrastructure, tools and standards. We've been working for some time to manage our AWS estate and establish a robust privileged access management system for our most sensitive engineering access, based on Microsoft Entra.

Two roles (one Senior, one Mid) will go to our **Engineering Access team**. This team is rolling out a Privileged Access Management system based on Microsoft Entra across all GDS production services. The goal is a robust system fully integrated across GDS's engineering estate, reducing TOIL and human error associated with manual access management, and ensuring engineering productivity.

The third role (Senior) will go to our **Cloud Platform team**. The cloud platform team currently own and operate our AWS estate, and over the next 6-9 months will take over operational responsibility for the Azure Landing zone developed as part of the Engineering Access work. Your role will be to provide Azure experience and expertise to support the team in this journey.

Job description

As an Site Reliability Engineer (Platform/Identity/Azure) you will:

- be part of a multidisciplinary team implementing and supporting our Azure cloud platform or Entra ID identity and access management system

- write infrastructure as code using terraform to ensure our infrastructure is consistent, reusable and reliable

- deploy and configure observability tools to enable our teams to identify and respond to operational issues quickly and effectively

- build CI/CD pipelines to enable the team to get code into production quickly and reliably

- provide day-to-day support for our platforms and tools to ensure they remain available, secure and robust

- participate in on-call rotations when necessary

- solve complex and interesting problems

share your knowledge and expertise with your peers and the wider team to drive consistency and develop a culture of openness and learning

In addition to the above, as a **Senior Site Reliability Engineer**, you will:

- line manage 1-2 technologists, supporting their growth and development

- provide technical leadership within a team, working with other team members to identify the best approaches and solutions

Read about [a day in the life of a GDS Site Reliability Engineer](#) on the GDS blog, and watch our video about [Becoming a site reliability engineer at GDS](#).

Person specification

We're interested in people who have:

- strong experience with cloud services, architecture and best practices in Microsoft Azure

- strong experience designing and implementing identity and access management systems using Entra ID, including Conditional Access, PIM and SCIM

- a Platform Engineering mindset, with a proficiency in designing and implementing scalable, resilient, and secure cloud platforms

- strong preference for infrastructure-as-code and automation using tools like Terraform

- experience of using container orchestration systems such as Kubernetes, AKS or serverless application design

- experience supporting large production services

- proficiency in at least one programming language (we use Ruby, Typescript, and Python)

- strong understanding of version control using Git

- experience of creating pipelines in a CI/CD tool like Github Actions or AWS Codepipeline

- a strong understanding of security principles and how to keep large operational services secure

In addition to the above, as a Senior Site Reliability Engineer you will have:

- experience of technical leadership, for example acting as a tech lead for a team or leading a technical initiative

- experience of line management, mentoring or coaching

If you meet a few of those criteria but think that you might not meet every last one then don't let that stop you from submitting an application.

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours

- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%

- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days

- an extra day off for the King's birthday

- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance

- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development

- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme

- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK

- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets

- death in service benefits

- cycle to work scheme and facilities

- access to an employee discounts scheme

- 10 learning days per year

- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)

- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

access to children's holiday play schemes across different locations in central London

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk>

Office attendance

The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.

DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

a simple application screening process - we only ask for a CV, responses to 2 knockout questions and a security check question Important tip - please

ensure that your responses include how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above

stage 1: a 30 minute telephone interview

stage 2: a 120 minute panel interview, including a 90 minute technical interview and a 30 minute civil service behavioural interview (conducted over video conferencing)

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

strong experience designing and implementing identity and access management systems using Entra ID, including Conditional Access, PIM and SCIM

In the Civil Service, we use [Success Profiles](#) to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We'll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we'll be assessing you against the following [Civil Service Behaviours](#):

working together

changing and improving

making effective decisions

We will also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the [DDaT DevOps role](#) or [Senior DevOps role](#) depending on which role you've applied for:

availability and capacity management

development process optimisation

information security

modern standards approach

programming and build (software engineering)
service support
systems design
systems integration

Want to know more about who Government Digital and Data are? [Click Here](#)

Recruitment Timeline

Sift completion: 1st September 2026

Phone Screens: w/c 7th September 2026

Panel and Technical interviews: 21st September 2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and [the Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Location:

Whilst this role's location is Manchester/London, if you are a current Civil servant working in DSIT and based in Bristol you are also able to apply for this role. If you are successful, you will retain your current location and pay.

Security:

Successful candidates must pass a disclosure and barring security check.

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and
family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status
under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and
family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application
for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement
Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who
were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who
have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of
behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in
the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As
such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with
disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil
servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum
requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever
it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

